

Lesson plan – Working as a catering assistant

Working as a catering assistant

Topic Vocabulary and functional language for a catering assistant's role.

Level: Entry 3 / National 4

Time: 90 minutes

Aim

- To become more familiar with the job description of a catering assistant
- To use language related to working in that role

Objectives

- Know nine key tasks a catering assistant does in their job
- Make polite requests in a catering kitchen
- Understand seven words/phrases you often see on a job description.

Introduction

- This lesson focuses on vocabulary to describe nine typical tasks a catering assistant does: – mop floors, wipe work surfaces, sweep up, chop, peel, serve meals, wash tea towels, load and unload the dishwasher. A listening task uses this vocabulary to make requests and learners practise making polite requests in role play situations and games.

You will need:

- **Resource 1a:** Catering photo montage - one per learner or one copy to project / display plus paper for learners to write their answers
- **Resources 2a and b:** one per learner
- **Resource 2 c** word cards cut up for learners with limited literacy
- **Resource 3** images for listening activity – one per learner
- **Resource 4 a** - one per learner unless at low level of literacy
- **Resource 4b:** flashcards – one class set (for less literate learners)
- **Resource 5:** dice game grid per group of three / four (Activity 4)
- Dice for each group of three / four
- **Audio:** Working as a catering assistant Activity 2

Lesson plan – Working as a catering assistant

Procedure

Activity 1 - Warmer - Introduction of topic and objectives (10 minutes)

- Hand out or display **resource 1a**. Show learners the picture montage and ask them to discuss what job it shows.
- Ask learners to note down other aspects of the job on **resource 1** (or on paper).
- Elicit feedback and then introduce lesson objectives.

Activity 2 – Learn key vocabulary for job description (20 minutes)

- Hand out **resource 2a**. Put learners into pairs. Ask learners to guess what task each picture represents. Don't give answers at this stage.
- Hand out **resource 2b**. In pairs, learners read the job description text. They try to match the numbers on the bold words with the appropriate picture on **resource 2**. (Note that the image of the dishwasher represents tasks 4 and 5).
- Model the first answer using an interactive white board (IWB) or enlarged copy of **resource 2a**. Read the first task in the text and learners call out possible answers. Confirm the correct answer and write the number next to the picture. Learners continue the activity in pairs.
- When learners have finished discussing, elicit and show correct answers on IWB or large copy.
- Where learners can, they should write the key words under the pictures on their copy of **resource 2a**.

Differentiation

- Read the text to learners who would find it difficult.
- Give learners with limited literacy a copy of **resource 2c** cut up into cards and ask them to match the phrases with the pictures.
- Ask them to work in pairs to say sentences e.g. '*you have to sweep up with the brush*'.

Activity 3 – Listening to polite requests (10 minutes)

- Ask learners to do something brusquely, but not rudely, and then more politely e.g. '*Give me a pen*', and then '*Can you give me a pen please?*'. Ask them if they can hear the difference and elicit that the second is polite and the first isn't.
- Focus learner attention on **resource 3** and explain that learners they are to write the correct number next to the picture according the order they hear the requests.
- Model the first question with the group. Play the recording or read the text twice or three times, if necessary.
- When finished, learners can compare answers in pairs. Then listen to the recording again and confirm the correct answers for learners to mark their work.

Lesson plan – Working as a catering assistant

Activity 4 – Speaking: Making polite requests (15 minutes)

- Look together at **resource 4a** and model the first answer. This could be done by writing the gapped sentence on the board.
- Working individually, learners fill in the gaps in the dialogue according to the picture stimulus.
- Monitor and check answers individually round the class as learners will need a clear, correct copy for the next stage.
- Learners read the dialogue in pairs. This could be modeled first by you and a more competent learner. Deal with any pronunciation or intonation issues that arise. For example, using rising intonation to show a question, showing which words in the sentence should have the most stress on them.
- Learners can use the last task (c) to check their learning. Ask them to work in pairs to match the two halves of the request, taking it in turns to read each one to their partner. Monitor and support as required.

Differentiation

- This can be done as a speaking only activity for those in the class with limited literacy. For example, show flashcards of the three tasks from **resource 4b**.
- Practise the three phrases as a whole class; listening and repeating the five main words in the phrases, '*Can you chop/wipe/peel the X*'.
- Count out the words on the fingers of one hand to remind learners how many they have to say.
- Check individual learners' learning by showing them a card and getting them to make the request.
- Set up a model role play situation with you as the chef and a more fluent learner as the catering assistant. Say the first polite phrase and invite the 'catering assistant' to respond to the request – "*yes / OK / no problem*". Give such options, if required. Follow the same procedure with the second and third flashcard.
- Now set up similar role plays between pairs. Keep the three flashcards visible to remind learners what requests to make. Monitor and give feedback.

Extension.

- If appropriate, elicit or add other ways of making requests which can be practised as a consolidation game e.g. '*Unload the dishwasher, will you?*' or '*Would you mind unloading the dishwasher?*' Say that the first is more informal and the second very polite. Point out that with the phrase '*Would you mind..*' the verb which follows always takes the -ing form.

Activity 5 – Speaking: Consolidation – making polite requests (25 minutes)

- Dice game. (**additional resource 1**)
 - The game is fun and competitive and the winner is the first player to have made all the 6 requests shown on the grid.
 - The first player rolls the dice and makes a request using the picture that corresponds with the number on the dice. e.g. Roll 5, Ask another learner in the group '*Abdul, Can you.....,please*' as shown in picture 5.

Lesson plan – Working as a catering assistant

- When the request has been made, the learner writes their initials in square #5. If the learner rolls #5 again later in the game, they have to miss their go. Players can only make each request once.
- The dice then passes to the next player who rolls it and makes a request of another learner using the picture corresponding to the number they have rolled. They then put their initial in the box and give the dice to the next player.
- The game continues until one player has their initials in all the boxes, which makes them the winner.

This game is best done in groups of three or four. You may need to model the game first to introduce the concept, if learners are likely to have difficulty following what to do just from oral instructions.

Cooler - Recap of lexis (5 minutes)

- Flashcard game. You will need a flashcard for each learner. Hand out one card each. Make a request orally 'Can you sweep up, please' and the learner with the corresponding card has to hold it up.
- Quick quiz 1: If learners are good writers, put into pairs or threes and ask them to write down as many of the nine aspects of the assistant's role as they can.
- Quick quiz 2: Split the class into two or three teams. Mime one of the nine tasks and the team which identifies the action first, gets a point.

Extension activity

- The extension activity focuses on formal/informal language in job descriptions and can be given as appropriate.

Answers

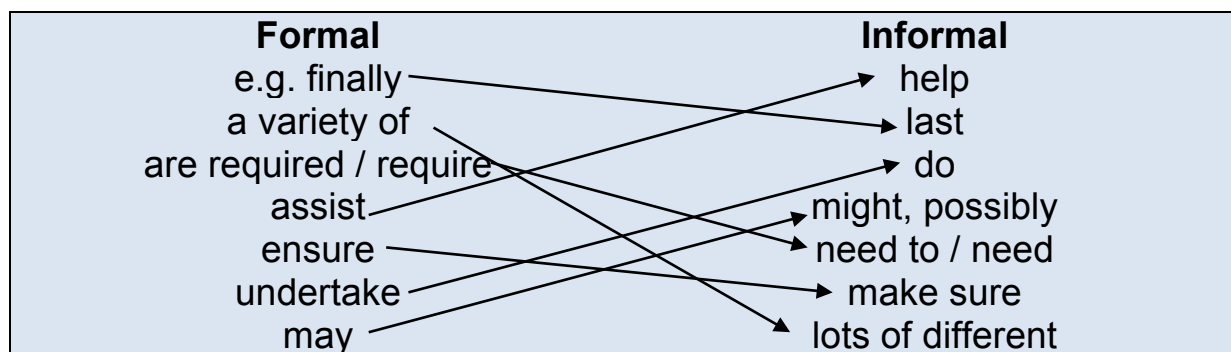
Listening – Activity 3

- 1 c) wipe the work surfaces
- 2 a) sweep up
- 3 f) unload the dishwasher
- 4 h) chop the carrots
- 5 g) wash the tea towels
- 6 b) mop the floors
- 7 e) peel the potatoes
- 8 d) serve the meals

Collocation matching – Activity 4c

1c 2d 3g 4b 5f 6a 7h 8e

Extension task



Lesson plan – Working as a catering assistant

Resource 1

Warmer: a) Look at the pictures below. What job do they show?



b) What else does this person do in their job? Make a list here.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

Lesson plan – Working as a catering assistant

.....

Resource 2a What catering assistants do.

a) Look at the pictures below.

Can you name each of the duties of a catering assistant?



Resource 2b What catering assistants do.

Read this description of what a catering assistant does. Match the nine phrases in **bold** with the eight pictures above.

Catering assistants undertake a variety of jobs in a kitchen. Firstly, they are responsible for hygiene and cleaning. They must **sweep up**¹, **mop the floors**², wash walls, **wipe the work surfaces**³ and appliances in the kitchen and also the dining area. They also **load**⁴ and **unload the dishwasher**⁵ and **wash the tea towels**⁶. Secondly, they are required to assist the chef. They need to ensure the chefs have all the equipment they require as well as prepare the food. They need to wash, **peel**⁷ and **chop**⁸ vegetables and cut meat or fish, sometimes using machinery. Finally, kitchen assistants may also **serve meals to customers**⁹.

Resource 2c Word cards to cut up

chop the carrots	peel the potatoes
sweep up	wipe the work surfaces
load the dishwasher	mop the floors
wash the tea towels	serve the meals

Lesson plan – Working as a catering assistant

Resource 3 Listen to the chef asking the catering assistant to do some tasks. Match the number of the chef's request with the picture.

a 	b 
c e.g. 1 	d 
e 	f 
g 	h 

Resource 4a Making requests

a) Read the conversation between a chef and a catering assistant. Look at the pictures and fill in the missing requests.

Chef: Can you



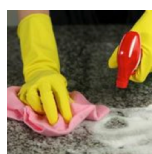
.....
please?

Catering assistant: Yeah, no problem.



.....
.....?

Catering assistant: Yeah, that's fine. Anything else?



.....?
Cheers.

.b) Now read the conversation with a partner.

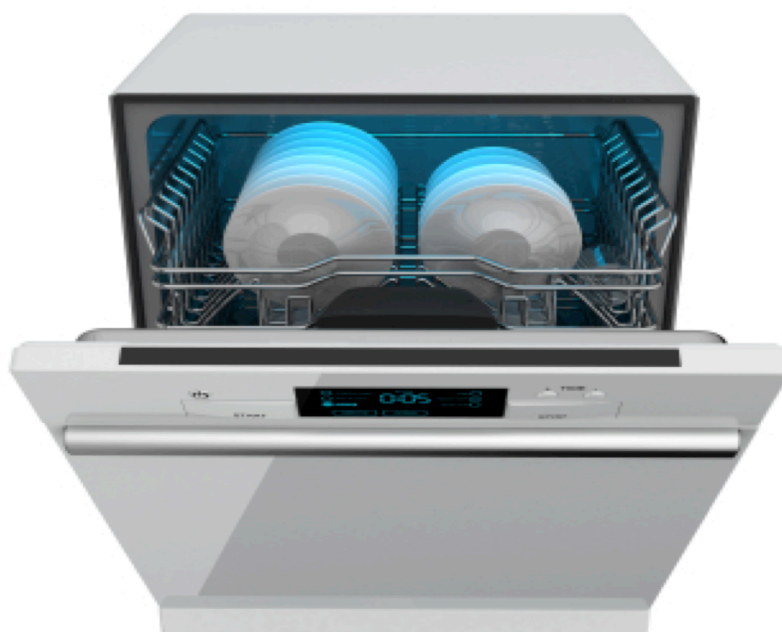
c) Match the two halves of the requests the chef makes.

- | | |
|------------------|--------------------|
| 1. Can you chop | a) the potatoes? |
| 2. Can you sweep | b) the meals? |
| 3. Can you mop | c) the carrots? |
| 4. Can you serve | d) up? |
| 5. Can you wipe | e) the tea towels? |
| 6. Can you peel | f) the tables? |
| 7. Can you load | g) the floors? |
| 8. Can you wash | h) the dishwasher? |
- An arrow points from the first item in the left column, '1. Can you chop', to the third item in the right column, 'c) the carrots?'.

Lesson plan – Working as a catering assistant

Resource 4b Flashcards to cut up





Lesson plan – Working as a catering assistant





Lesson plan – Working as a catering assistant

Resource 5 Dice Game

 1	 2	 3
 4	 5	 6

 1	 2	 3
 4	 5	 6

Lesson plan – Working as a catering assistant

Resource 6 Extension task – formal vocabulary

1) Read the text about catering assistants again. This job description uses some formal words – these words are in **bold**. What do you think they mean?

Catering assistants **undertake a variety of** jobs in a kitchen. Firstly, they are responsible for hygiene and cleaning. They must sweep up, mop the floors, wash walls, wipe the work surfaces and appliances in the kitchen and also the dining area. They also load and unload the dishwasher and wash the tea towels. Secondly, they **are required to assist** the chef. They need to **ensure** the chefs have all the equipment they **require** as well as prepare the food. They need to wash, peel and chop vegetables and cut meat or fish, sometimes using machinery. **Finally**, kitchen assistants **may** also serve meals to customers.

2 a)



Picture 1 shows a formal work situation and we wear formal, smart clothes.

Picture 2 shows an informal cafe situation and we wear our everyday clothes.

When we speak we use informal words for our everyday conversations and formal words for situations such as interviews and written texts like some job adverts or job descriptions.

b) Can you match the formal word from the text with the same informal meaning?

Formal	Informal
e.g. finally	help
a variety of	last
are required / require	do
assist	might, possibly
ensure	need to / need
undertake	make sure
may	lots of different

Ask your teacher for the answers.

Audio script Listening to polite requests

Listen to the chef asking a kitchen assistant to do some tasks

- 1 Can you wipe the work surfaces?
- 2 Can you sweep up?
- 3 Can you unload the dishwasher please?
- 4 Can you chop the carrots?
- 5 Can you wash the tea towels?
- 6 Can you mop the floors please?
- 7 Can you peel the potatoes?
- 8 Can you serve the meals please?